# CS 4300/5300 Software Engineering

Sprint 0-2: User Stories, Lo-Fi UI, and Storyboards

## 1 Purpose

You have been assigned a customer. Now you turn their ideas into work your team can begin working on. This is the largest Sprint 0 deliverable, and the one your next four sprints depend on. A weak backlog here produces four sprints of confusion.

## 2 Sprint 0-2 Objectives

| Requirement | Points |
|---|---|
| High-level user stories (at least 4) | 25 pts |
| Story decomposition (at least 6) | 25 pts |
| Lo-fi UI alignment | 15 pts |
| Storyboard clarity | 10 pts |
| Gherkin acceptance criteria | 10 pts |
| Sprint planning logic | 10 pts |
| Cohesion and professional quality | 5 pts |
| **Total** | **100 pts** |

## 3 Detailed Requirements

### 3.1 High-Level User Stories (25 pts)

Write at least **four** high-level stories describing the core capabilities of your application. Each must use the Connextra format:

*As a* [user], *I want to* [goal], *So that* [reason/value].

Each story must be SMART—specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and scoped to a meaningful user-visible capability. You will lose points for stories that omit the "So that" clause, state vague goals such as "manage stuff," are too granular to be high-level, or are too broad to finish in the semester.

### 3.2 Story Decomposition (25 pts)

Break your high-level stories into at least **six** decomposed stories, each with Gherkin scenarios, sized to fit inside a single sprint. Each decomposed story must trace clearly back to one of your high-level stories, and must also use the Connextra format. Separate your high-level stories from your decomposed stories clearly in the submission.

### 3.3 Lo-Fi UI Alignment (15 pts)

Produce low-fidelity mockups covering your high-level stories. Show the major screens, the navigation between them, and the key user actions on each.

These should be sketches or wireframes. Polished high-fidelity mockups are not what is being asked for, and they cost you time you do not have.

### 3.4 Storyboard Clarity (10 pts)

For each high-level story, draw a storyboard: a short sequence of lo-fi sketches, one frame per step, showing what the user sees and does at each moment (see SWEBook §3.5.3, Storyboards: Drawing the Scenario). A written description alone does not count as a storyboard.

- **Pictures in sequence.** Four to eight frames per storyboard, ordered left to right or numbered. Together the frames show how the user enters the workflow, what actions they take, what the system shows in response, and what successful completion looks like.
- **Lo-fi on purpose.** Boxes, arrows, stick figures, and hand lettering, drawn in minutes on paper, a whiteboard, or a simple drawing tool. Photos of hand sketches are fine. Polished visual design is not what is being asked for.
- **Short captions.** Give each frame a one-line caption naming the step. The picture carries the story; the caption labels it.
- **Include at least one exception.** Across your storyboards, draw at least one failure or difficult path (for example, an empty search result or invalid input) alongside the ideal path.

Your storyboards should use the same screens as your lo-fi UI, so the two sections tell one story.

### 3.5 Gherkin Acceptance Criteria (10 pts)

Write acceptance criteria as Gherkin scenarios—**Given**, **When**, **Then**—on your decomposed stories in GitHub Projects. These scenarios become the tests you write in Sprint 1, so write them as statements about observable behavior. You will be demonstrating these scenarios in class throughout the semester.

### 3.6 Sprint Planning Logic (10 pts)

Set up a GitHub Projects board containing every story in a backlog, and distribute your decomposed stories across four sprint groupings. Your plan should deliver visible user value early, build functionality incrementally, and avoid concentrating unrealistic scope in any one sprint. Putting every story in Sprint 1 and leaving later sprints empty is not a plan.

### 3.7 Cohesion and Professional Quality (5 pts)

Combine all artifacts into one document. Sections should align with each other—the stories, the UI, the storyboards, and the sprint plan should all describe the same application.

## 4 Submission Requirements

### On Canvas (1 person per team)

- Submit a single document containing all artifacts above

### On GitHub Projects

- All stories entered as cards in the backlog
- Gherkin acceptance criteria recorded on decomposed stories

### AI Documentation

Document in your project README where and when you got help from AI: the tool you used, what it helped with, and how you used the result. You do not need to include transcripts or chat logs.